

DM ADS ATTRIBUTION

The first software for fitness coaches running DM ad funnels.

Know which ad actually made you money.
Down to the dollar, per ad, updating on its own.



by Alex Walsh

Setup guide, and how it works

github.com/alexwalsh520-dot/ads-v2

Let me guess how you do this right now

You launch a campaign. You start a new Google Sheet for it, because the last one got messy.

Every few days you open Ads Manager, look at what you spent, and type it into the sheet. You ask your setter how many people booked. You type that in too. At the end of the month you look at what came in and type that in as well.

Then you sit there and try to work out which ad did it. And honestly, you cannot. You have a spend number, a revenue number, and a feeling.

You are not bad at this. Nobody ever built the thing that would let you do it properly. That is what this is.

Why Facebook cannot help you

If you sent people to a website, Facebook would know everything. Someone taps your ad, lands on your page, buys, and Facebook watches the whole thing and tells you which ad did it.

DM ads do not work that way. The moment someone sends you a DM, everything moves into Instagram messages. Facebook cannot see the conversation. It cannot see the call get booked. It cannot see the money.

So the one column you actually want, **which ad produced buyers**, does not exist in Ads Manager. It never has, and it never will.

And the number it does show you is not real

Facebook shows you a cost per DM. Do not trust it.

Facebook counts a "conversation" far more loosely than you would. Someone who taps your ad and types nothing can still get counted. So the number looks better than the truth, and it is the number you have been making budget decisions on.

Your real cost per DM is almost always worse than what is on the screen. Which means some of the ads you think are working are not.

PART ONE

What you get instead

One page. One row per ad. Everything that ad actually produced, all the way to cash.

AD	SPENT	DMS	BOOKED	SHOWED	SALES	CASH	ROAS
STRONG	\$840	94	22	14	3	\$4,100	4.9x
SHREDDER	\$610	71	9	5	1	\$1,200	2.0x
SUMMIT	\$600	52	4	1	0	\$0	0.0x

Made-up numbers, but that is the shape of it. And look how obvious the decision becomes. SUMMIT has eaten \$600 and produced nothing. STRONG is printing. You would never have seen that in Ads Manager, because Ads Manager stops at the DM.

And you stop typing things in

This is the part people underrate. Once it is running:

- your ad spend comes in by itself, every hour
- every DM records itself the second it lands
- every booked call records itself
- your sales come out of the tracker you already keep

Nobody logs anything. You are not chasing your setter for numbers on a Monday. You are not starting a new sheet for the next campaign. You open one page and it is already correct.

Every campaign and every ad set you launch from then on is tracked from the minute it goes live. You do not have to do anything to add it.

How much of this do you have to build?

Hardly any. You paste a link into Claude and answer questions about your business. It does the building.

Your side is four things to copy from four websites, and about twenty minutes inside ManyChat, which this guide walks you through click by click.

PART TWO

How it actually works

Worth ten minutes. Understand this bit and the rest of the setup makes sense, and you will know straight away why a number looks wrong later on.

Your keyword works like a promo code

You already know how a promo code works. You give one code to one podcast and a different code to another. When the orders come in, the code tells you which one sent them. Same product, same checkout, the code is the only thing that separates them.

Your keyword is that code.

Your ad says DM me STRONG. Anyone who sends you STRONG came from that ad. Not probably. Definitely.

Which is why one ad gets one word

Think about what happens if you give the same promo code to two podcasts. The orders come in, they all say the same code, and you have no idea which show actually worked. The code stops telling you anything.

Exactly the same here. One ad, one word. If two ads are both running STRONG at the same time, and someone DMs STRONG and buys, nothing on earth can tell you which ad earned it.

So every live ad gets its own word. That is the whole rule.

Let us follow one person

Sarah is scrolling Instagram on a Tuesday.

1. She sees your ad. It says DM me the word STRONG. Behind the scenes this ad is named STRONG in Ads Manager, so the system already knows every dollar spent on it belongs to the word STRONG.

2. She DMs you STRONG. ManyChat replies to her, the same as it does today. But now it also quietly writes down two things: who Sarah is, and that she said STRONG. That is one

DM on the STRONG row.

3. Your setter chats to her. Nothing changes here. Normal conversation.

4. Your setter books her. Instead of pasting the calendar link by hand, they put a tag on her, a sticker, basically. You will build a small automation (this guide walks you through it) that watches for that sticker and sends the calendar link the moment it appears. And the link it sends has STRONG tucked inside it, where Sarah never sees it. That is one booked call on the STRONG row.

5. Your setter pastes her ManyChat link into your sales sheet, right there, at the moment they book her. Three seconds, while they are still looking at the conversation. This is the one genuinely new habit in the whole system.

6. She turns up, and she buys. Your closer fills in the sheet exactly as they do today: ticks that she showed, writes what she paid. Nothing new for them at all.

7. That is what the dashboard reads. Because Sarah's ManyChat link is sitting on that row, the system knows this row is Sarah, and it already knew Sarah was STRONG.

Done. \$2,000 lands on the STRONG row. You now know, for a fact, that ad produced a paying client.

That is the entire system. The keyword survives every step. Everything in the setup exists to make one of those handoffs happen without anybody having to think about it.

PART TWO

You are not adding a new job

This is worth being straight about, because it is the thing that makes or breaks whether this actually works for you.

Nothing here detects who showed up to a call. No software can. It knows because **somebody ticked a box in your sales tracker**, the same box your closer already ticks after every call.

That is the whole trick. You are not building a new process on top of your business. You are turning the admin your team already does into an attribution system.

Who does what

The handoff	Who does it
Ad → keyword	You , when you name the ad
Keyword → DM	Automatic, once ManyChat is set up
DM → booked call	Automatic, from the tag your setter applies
Booked call → the person	Whoever books it , pasting the ManyChat link on the row
Did they show up	Your closer , ticking the column they already tick
Did they buy, and for how much	Your closer , filling the columns they already fill

Look at that list again. Four of the six are either automatic or something your team is already doing today. The only genuinely new habit is pasting the ManyChat link when you book someone, and that is three seconds while you are already looking at the conversation.

Which also means the reverse is true. If your tracker stops getting filled in, your show rate and your revenue go blank. Not wrong, blank. The system will not invent them. So the discipline your team already has around the tracker is now doing double duty: it runs your sales process AND it powers every number on the dashboard.

What happens when a handoff breaks

Nothing dramatic. The chain stops there for that one person, and the system tells you instead of making something up.

If an ad is named wrong, that ad shows its spend and zeros everywhere else. If the ManyChat link is missing from a row, that sale shows as **unattributed**, real money, unknown source.

This is the most important promise in the whole thing. It will never guess. If it cannot prove a sale came from a particular ad, it says so. Money you can see is unaccounted for is a problem you can go and fix. Money quietly credited to the wrong ad would have you scaling the wrong thing and never finding out. The blanks are a feature, not a fault.

PART THREE

Two habits, forever

No software can do these for you. Skipping them is the number one reason somebody ends up staring at an empty dashboard wondering what went wrong.

Habit 1, name the ad after the keyword

When you make an ad in Ads Manager you give it a name. Whatever word that ad tells people to DM you, that is the name.

Your ad tells people to send	Name the ad
STRONG	STRONG
SHREDDER	SHREDDER
SUMMIT	SUMMIT

That is genuinely it. Nothing else in the name. The keyword on its own is the cleanest way to do it, and it is how I name mine.

Want other stuff in the name too? Fine, but the keyword must be LAST. The system reads the **last word** of the name. So Vets 35 | STRONG works fine and reads as STRONG. But STRONG retarget reads as "retarget", and that ad will never be credited with anything, ever. If in doubt, just name it the keyword.

An ad named wrong is not broken and nothing will warn you. It sits in your list showing its spend, with zeros in every other column, forever. That is the system being honest: it cannot tie a single DM to that ad, so it will not pretend it can.

Habit 2, one keyword, one live ad

The promo code rule from earlier. Never have two ads running at the same time that both say DM me STRONG.

Using a word again months later is fine. Just leave a few weeks after switching the first one off, so a straggler DM from the old ad does not get credited to the new one.

PART THREE

Your sales tracker

You already keep one. It stays exactly where it is, and you keep working in it exactly the same way. The system just reads it.

Two promises about your spreadsheet. It can only READ your sheet. It can never write to it, change it, move your columns or reorganise anything. And it never converts your money between currencies, what you typed is what it shows.

One sheet, not one per campaign

If you currently start a fresh sheet for every campaign, stop doing that. Use one sheet.

The only reason you were splitting them was to keep campaigns apart. That is now a column the system fills in for you, automatically, per ad. Far better than a separate file.

The columns it reads

You almost certainly have most of these already. The names do not matter and the order does not matter, Claude reads your sheet, works out which column is which, and shows you so you can confirm it got it right.

Column	What it is for
Date	which day the call was. Required
Name	who it was. Required
ManyChat link	the big one. How a sale gets tied back to the DM, and so to the ad
Did they show	your show rate, and it separates a no-show from a lost sale
Cash collected	money actually in the bank. ROAS is worked out from this
Total contracted	the full deal value, for when it is more than you took today
Outcome	won, lost, no-show, follow-up

Column	What it is for
Closer and Setter	who took it, who set it

You probably need to add one column

The **ManyChat link** column. Most people do not have this yet, and it is the single most valuable column in the sheet.

Why it matters so much: without it, a sale gets matched to a DM by name. Two Sarahs, someone using a nickname, a typo, a maiden name, and the match quietly fails. With the link it is exact, every single time.

Whoever books the call fills it in, when they book it

Not at the end of the week. Not when the sale closes. **At the moment they book the call.**

They open that person in ManyChat, copy the link out of the address bar, and paste it on that person's row. Three seconds, while they are already looking at the conversation.

Do it later and it will not happen. The conversation will be twelve messages back, they will not remember which Sarah it was, and the row stays blank.

Add this column today, before you set anything else up. Rows already in your sheet without it can never be matched afterwards. Every day you wait is another day of sales that can never be traced back to an ad.

The two columns your closer already fills in

Whether they showed up, and what they paid.

Nothing detects these. Nothing can. Your show rate comes from that tick box, and your revenue and ROAS come from that number. The dashboard is reading your team's admin, which is exactly why it costs you no extra work.

It also means the discipline you already have around the tracker now does two jobs. It runs your sales process, and it powers every number on the dashboard. If the tracker goes unfilled for a week, your show rate and revenue go blank for that week. Blank, not wrong. The system will not invent them.

PART FOUR

Setting it up

Open Claude Code, paste in the link below, and tell it to install this.

```
https://github.com/alexwalsh520-dot/ads-v2
```

It will ask you questions about your business, what you use for DMs, what you book calls with, what your ad account is. Then it builds the whole thing. You do not edit any files or write anything technical.

If you get stuck anywhere, tell it what you can see on your screen. That genuinely works, it will pick up from wherever you are.

Four things to go and copy

Claude cannot log into your accounts, so these four are on you. Get them first and everything else goes quickly.

	What	Where from	What it is for
1	Supabase personal access token	supabase.com	Where your numbers get stored
2	Meta ad account id and token	business.facebook.com	Your ad spend
3	Vercel access token	vercel.com	Puts your dashboard on the internet
4	Your sales tracker link	Google Sheets	Your money

What is a "token"? A very long password that lets one app talk to another on your behalf. You generate it, copy it once, paste it in, and never look at it again. That is the whole idea.

1. Supabase, where your numbers get stored

A database is just a filing cabinet for numbers. This one is free at the size you need.

Supabase has several different keys. You want ONE specific one. Inside a Supabase project you will find things called anon, service role, publishable and secret keys. **You do not want any of those.** You want an account-level **personal access token**, which lives somewhere completely different, under your account settings, not inside a project. Follow the steps below exactly and you will land in the right place.

- 1 Go to **supabase.com** and make an account. You do **not** need to create a project, Claude does that part for you.
- 2 Go straight to this address: **supabase.com/dashboard/account/tokens**
- 3 Check the page title says **Access Tokens** and that you are in your **account** settings, not inside a project.
- 4 Click **Generate new token**. Give it a name like ads dashboard.
- 5 Copy it. It starts with sbp_, that prefix is how you know you got the right one. Supabase only shows it once.
- 6 Paste it to Claude.

PART FOUR

2. Meta, your ad spend

Two pieces: which ad account, and permission to read it.

Your ad account id

Open **Ads Manager**. It is at the top left, next to the account name. It looks like `act_123456789`. Copy the whole thing, including the `act_` bit.

Your access token

There are two kinds, and you want the one that never expires. The ordinary kind dies after about two months and takes your dashboard down with no warning, usually on a day you actually needed it.

- 1 Go to **business.facebook.com**, then **Business Settings**
- 2 In the left menu find **Users**, then **System Users**
- 3 Click **Add**. Name it anything. Set the role to **Admin**.
- 4 Click **Add Assets**, then **Ad Accounts**, tick your ad account, and turn on **Manage campaigns**
- 5 Click **Generate New Token**. Pick your app. Tick **ads_read** and **ads_management**. Set expiry to **Never**.
- 6 Copy it. Facebook only shows it to you once.

This is the fiddliest thing in the whole setup. If you get lost, tell Claude the name of the screen you are looking at and it will pick up from there. Everything after this is easier.

3. Vercel, where your dashboard lives

This is what turns it into a real website with a real address, instead of something that only works while your laptop is open.

The Scope setting matters. Pick Full Account. Vercel lets you limit a token to one project. That sounds sensible and it will **break the setup**, your project does not exist yet, so a project-limited token has nothing to point at and cannot create one. Choose **Full Account**.

- 1 Go to **vercel.com** and make an account.
- 2 At the top left of the dashboard, make sure you are looking at your **personal account**, not a team.
- 3 Go to **vercel.com/account/tokens**
- 4 Click **Create Token**. Give it a name like ads dashboard.
- 5 Under **Scope**, choose **Full Account**.
- 6 Choose an expiration. Pick the longest option offered, when it expires, your dashboard stops updating until you make a new one.
- 7 Click **Create**, then copy the token. It starts with vcp_ and is only shown once.

4. Your sales tracker

- 1 Open your sales tracker in Google Sheets.
- 2 Click **Share**, top right.
- 3 Under **General access**, change **Restricted** to **Anyone with the link**. Leave it set to **Viewer**.
- 4 Copy the link out of your browser's address bar and paste it to Claude.

That is all you do. Claude reads your column names itself and tells you which column it thinks is which. You just check it got them right.

PART FIVE

ManyChat

The longest part, so take your time. It is also the part that makes the whole thing work, so it is worth going slowly.

What you almost certainly have right now

One automation. A trigger that fires when someone sends your keyword, and a message that goes back to them. Two boxes joined by a line:

```
[ When someone sends "STRONG" ] ----> [ Send them a message ]
```

That is a perfectly good setup and you are not throwing any of it away. You are adding to it.

What you are adding

- **Part A**, one new box, slotted in **between** those two, so every DM records itself
- **Part B**, one brand new automation, so booking someone also records which ad they came from

Before you start, check you are on ManyChat Pro. One of the steps below (External Request) is a paid feature. If you cannot find it in the menu, that is why, it is not you being blind. Upgrading is the fix.

Part A, recording every DM

Open the automation that already replies to your keyword. You will see your keyword trigger, and your message box, joined by a line.

The new box goes BETWEEN them, not at the end. It has to run before anything else happens, so the keyword gets saved the instant the DM lands. You are inserting a step into the middle of a chain you already have, trigger first, then your new box, then your message.

So you are going from this:

```
[ trigger ] ----> [ message ]
```

To this:

```
[ trigger ] ----> [ NEW: action box ] ----> [ message ]
```

If you use a randomiser to split conversations between two setters, the new box goes between the trigger and the randomiser. Same idea, it comes first.

Building it

- 1 In the flow builder, add a new step using the **+** button, and choose **Action**. A new empty box appears on the canvas.
- 2 Drag the line so it goes **trigger → your new action box → your message**. You may need to unhook the existing line from the trigger first, then join it back up through the new box.

What is an "Action" box? A little to-do list ManyChat runs for that person before it moves on. You have probably never added one. It does not send them anything and they never see it.

Now put two things inside that box.

First, save which word they sent.

What is a "custom field"? ManyChat keeps a card on every person who messages you, their name, when they first wrote, and so on. A custom field is a blank box on that card that you get to name and fill in yourself. You are about to make one called **keyword** and put the word that person sent you into it. That is all a custom field is.

- 1 Inside the action box click **+ Add Action**, and pick **Set User Field**.
- 2 For the field, choose to create a new one, and call it **keyword**.
- 3 For the value, pick **Last Text Input** from the list.

"Last Text Input" means: whatever they just typed. This is the clever bit. Because you are saving what they actually sent, **ONE automation handles all of your keywords at once.** You do not need one for STRONG and another for SHREDDER. Put every keyword on the same trigger and each person records themselves correctly.

Second, send it over to your dashboard.

Still inside the same action box, click **+ Add Action** again and pick **External Request**.

What is an "External Request"? It is ManyChat telling another app that something just happened. Like a text message from ManyChat to your dashboard saying "Sarah just sent STRONG". Nobody sees it, and it takes a fraction of a second.

Claude gives you the exact address to paste in, and exactly what to put in each box. Follow what it gives you, it is filled in for your account specifically.

You will see a red "Invalid JSON" warning. Ignore it. ManyChat shows that while you are editing, because there is no real person for it to test with yet. It goes away the moment a genuine DM comes through. It is not an error and you have not done anything wrong.

Save it. Part A is done, every DM now records itself.

PART FIVE

Part B, recording every booked call

This is a brand new automation, separate from the one above. You have almost certainly never built anything like it, and it is the highest-value twenty minutes in this guide.

What you do today

When your setter is ready to book someone, they paste your calendar link into the chat by hand.

That link tells you nothing. Someone books through it and it arrives with no idea who they are or which ad they came from. That is exactly why bookings are impossible to attribute at the moment.

What you are replacing it with

Your setter puts a **tag** on the person instead. ManyChat spots the tag, sends the calendar link automatically, and slips that person's keyword inside the link on the way out.

Same effort for the setter. Less, actually, one click instead of hunting for a link and pasting it.

What is a "tag"? A sticker you put on a person in ManyChat. That is genuinely all it is. You make up the name. The useful part is that ManyChat can watch for a sticker being applied and do something the moment it happens, which is exactly what you are about to build.

Build it

- 1 In ManyChat go to **Settings**, then **Tags**, and make a new tag. Name it after the calendar it will send, something like `1_Day_Calendar`. If you offer more than one calendar, make one tag for each.
- 2 Go to **Automation** and start a **New Automation**. This is a separate one, not the keyword automation you edited in Part A.

- 3 For the trigger, choose **Contact event occurs**, then **Tag applied**, then pick the tag you just made.
- 4 Add one step: **Send Message**.
- 5 In that message, put your normal booking link, then add the keyword onto the end of it, exactly as described below.

Adding the keyword to the link

What you are about to do, in plain terms. You are sticking a small label on the end of your booking link. When Sarah clicks it, the label travels along with her and lands in your booking tool, so it knows she came from STRONG. She never sees it and it changes nothing for her.

Take your booking link and add this onto the end:

```
?utm_content=
```

...then insert your keyword field straight after the = sign

So a finished link looks like this, where the last part is your keyword field, not typed-out text:

```
https://your-booking-link.com/strategy-call?utm_content={keyword}
```

To insert the field: while you are writing the message, use ManyChat's field picker, the little { } button, and choose your **keyword** field. Do not type the word out with brackets around it yourself.

THE MOST IMPORTANT CHECK IN THIS WHOLE GUIDE: it has to be BLUE. When you insert the field properly, ManyChat shows it as a **blue chip** in the message. If it is plain black text, ManyChat will send the literal characters {keyword} to every single lead, and not one booking will ever be attributed. So look at it. Is it blue? Good. If it is black, delete it and insert it again using the field picker.

If you offer more than one calendar, a one-day and a three-day, say, each tag needs its own automation, and every one of those links needs the keyword on it.

Tell your setter what changed

Two things change for them, and both need saying out loud:

- To book someone, **apply the tag**. The link goes out by itself. Do not paste the old link by hand, those bookings arrive with nothing attached.
- Then **paste that person's ManyChat link into the sales sheet**, straight away, on the row for that booking.

Last piece: your booking tool

Whatever you book calls with, GoHighLevel, Calendly, anything, needs to tell the dashboard when a call actually gets booked.

The menus are named differently in every tool, so tell Claude which one you use and it will give you the exact steps for yours.

Which calendars count as sales calls

Claude asks you this during setup, before you ever open the dashboard. You just say which of your calendars are **sales calls**, not onboarding calls, not coaching calls. Those are real bookings, they are just not the thing you are measuring here.

PART SIX

You are done

You have your own web address, something like `your-name.vercel.app`, behind a password you picked.

It updates itself every hour, whether your laptop is on or not.

Check these four before you trust it

Check	If it comes back empty
Your ad spend is showing	Tell Claude, usually the Meta token
Send yourself a test DM with one of your keywords. It shows up in the DM column	The action box did not save, or it is after the message instead of before it
Put your booking tag on yourself. You get the link, and it has the keyword on the end of it	The keyword is black, not blue
Ask Claude to run the setup check. It comes back clean	It will tell you what to fix

Do not skip these. A setup that finished but shows an empty table is not finished, and you will not notice for a week.

Give it two weeks before you judge an ad

The dashboard is instant. Your sales cycle is not. Someone who DMs you today might buy in ten days. A brand new ad showing zero sales on day two is not a bad ad, it is an ad you have not waited for yet.

Cost per DM and cost per booked call tell you something within a couple of days. ROAS needs longer.

Why this is worth doing now

Right now you are making budget decisions on a number Facebook inflates and a feeling about which ads are working. That is not a small problem. It is the difference

between your current revenue and your next level.

- **You stop wasting spend.** The ad quietly eating \$600 a month and producing nothing becomes obvious on day one instead of never.
- **You scale the right thing.** When you find the ad that actually produces buyers, you can put real money behind it and know it will hold.
- **You get your time back.** No more Monday mornings pulling numbers together. No more asking your setter what happened last week.
- **You decide faster.** The gap between "something changed" and "I know what changed" goes from weeks to hours.

Every week you run without this is a week of spend you cannot account for, and a week of data you will never get back. Set it up once and it runs forever.

When something looks off

Tell Claude what you are seeing, in normal words. There is a check built in that catches most of it. The usual suspects:

What you see	What it almost always is
One ad shows spend and zeros everywhere else	Its name does not end in its keyword
No DMs at all	The action box is missing, in the wrong place, or you are not on Pro
Bookings arriving with no keyword on them	The keyword in the booking link is black, not blue
No booked calls at all	Your sales calendars were never marked
Booked calls look too low	Two calendars with nearly the same name, splitting them
Sales showing as unattributed	No ManyChat link pasted on those rows
Everything froze on a certain date	Your Meta token expired. Make a System User one

Stuck on anything? Ask your Claude first, it has the full setup instructions and it knows this system inside out. If you are still stuck after that, come and ask me. More than happy to help you get it working.

And the whole thing in one sentence: the keyword goes at the end of the ad name, gets saved when they DM you, rides inside the booking link, and lands on the sales row your team already fills in.